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Companies may offer products as per curriculum and for general interest."

Five years down the line

Saurikha states, "There is a wide scope for education-and-training-kits market to be shaped up in India. Indian companies will have an advantage in aggregating the demand for such products, which is spread out across various institutions and key cities in the country."

Vidyashankar concludes, "According to a number of studies, if the present rate of electronics use continues, by 2020 or 2022 the total demand for electronics will be around 400 billion dollars, and out of this 400 billion dollars, about 300 billion dollars will need to be imported. Now think about this—can the country sustain this kind of import? Impossible! Hence, we need to focus on indigenous manufacturing. To meet this mark, the skill require-

ment will be of utmost importance. We just need to fine-tune the requirements of the industry with that being delivered from the institutes. We already produce the largest engineering manpower in the world; we just need to fine tune the skills and we have already started to focus on that."

Although this industry is not stagnant at present,

the growth is very slow. Plenty of initiatives have been taken but in small chunks, and they do not affect the industry directly. All the challenges have to be met and the government will have to play a major role in helping this industry grow, as growth of this industry will lead to the growth of the electronics industry as a whole. ●

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